Daniel Liu

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AI researcher and engineer working on post-training, evaluation, and agent systems, from research to production.

EXPERIENCE

AI-native marketing startup — *Founder* 2026

- Built a multi-agent marketing platform from zero. Owned engineering and go-to-market, and won multiple paid client engagements.
- Designed two modes: read-only analysis, and execution that waited for a person's approval before changing anything in an ad account.
- Connected Meta, Google, LinkedIn, TikTok, and Amazon ad accounts through OAuth.

Meta — *Staff Software Engineer, ML/AI (promoted from Software Engineer to Senior to Staff)* 2020–2026

- More than five years building ML and AI systems, from Messenger Kids ML to ads ranking and recommendation, and then to LLM agents for advertisers.

Meta AI for Business — Founding AI Researcher 2024–2026

- Founding AI researcher on Meta's AI assistant for advertisers.
- Led product direction and core agent-system design for a 100+ person initiative spanning four Meta organizations.
- Built the post-training and evaluation loop end to end: SFT, DPO and GRPO, human and LLM-judge evals, and launch gates.

SMB Ads ML — Tech Lead 2023–2024

- Tech lead on ad delivery optimization and recommendation systems for small and mid-sized advertisers.
- Shipped Meta's first ML-powered personalized budget recommendation system for SMB advertisers.
- Led SMB ads work that drove $100M+ in ad platform revenue.

Instagram Ads Ranking & Messenger Kids ML — ML Engineer 2020–2023

- Shipped ML into Instagram ads ranking and delivery.
- Started at Meta on Messenger Kids ML.

Meta — *Software Engineer Intern, Speech* 2020

- Contributed to the open-source Fairseq toolkit.

Google — *Software Engineer Intern, Ads Quality* 2019

- Worked on ML for ads spam detection.

EDUCATION

University of Illinois Urbana-Champaign 2020

- M.S., Computer Engineering · GPA 3.87/4.0
- B.S., Electrical Engineering · Highest Honors · James Scholar · Dean's List

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

UIUC — *Research Assistant, advised by Prof. David Forsyth* 2018–2020

- Deep learning for fashion compatibility and controllable outfit generation, which led to an arXiv preprint.

UIUC — *Research Assistant, DEPEND Group (Prof. R.K. Iyer), in collaboration with Mayo Clinic* 2017–2019

- Deep learning for clinical outcome prediction from longitudinal patient data.

PUBLICATIONS & PATENTS

Methods and Systems to Improve Post Opportunities 2025

U.S. Patent Application Publication US 2025/0148501 A1 · co-inventor (as Chen Liu)

- Uses large language models to help small businesses create and improve ads.

Coherent and Controllable Outfit Generation 2019
Kedan Li, Chen Liu, David Forsyth · arXiv preprint arXiv:1906.07273

SKILLS

Languages: Python, C++, SQL, TypeScript
Machine learning: PyTorch · post-training (SFT, DPO, GRPO) · evaluation design (human and LLM-judge evals) · LLM agents and multi-agent orchestration · ranking and recommender systems · reinforcement learning · computer vision
Infrastructure: Spark, Docker, Kubernetes, FastAPI, AWS